Homage to the Blessed One, Blazing Uṣṇīṣa

Toh 962 · Derge Kangyur

བཅོམ་ལྡན་འདས་གཙུག་ཏོར་འབར་བ་ལ་ཕྱག་འཚལ་ལོ།

The Blazing Uṣṇīṣa Dhāraṇī, known in Tibetan as Tsuktor Barwa and in Sanskrit roughly as the Uṣṇīṣa Jvala, is a very short incantation text that opens with homage to the Blessed One, Blazing Uṣṇīṣa, the radiant crown protuberance of a buddha personified as a deity. After the homage it gives a single mantra, addressed to all the buddhas whose teaching is unobstructed, that calls on the deity to blaze forth and asks that every ill omen and bad dream be pacified. A brief verse passage then praises the mantra as belonging to a thousand buddhas, claiming that it accomplishes countless kinds of activity, brings auspiciousness, glory, and renown, and dispels bad dreams and evil signs when recited even once. The work is Toh 962 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the protective and auspicious incantations gathered in the canon's dhāraṇī collection.

Homage to the Blessed One, Blazing Uṣṇīṣa!

namaḥ smanta buddhānāṃ apratihataśāsanānāṃ oṃ gagabāhi khāhi hūṃ hūṃ jvala jvala brajvala prajvala tiṣṭha tiṣṭha phaṭ phaṭ sarva durnimitta duḥsvapna śīntaṃ kuru svāhā

This mantra of a thousand buddhas
Is renowned as Blazing Uṣṇīṣa.
Whatever actions there may be, thousands
Numbering eighty, and five times nine,
Actions of every various kind,
And all auspiciousness, glory and fame, it brings about.
Bad dreams and evil omens
It dispels by being recited a single time.

The dhāraṇī called Blazing Uṣṇīṣa is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The number of actions in the verse is unclear. The Tibetan reads literally "thousands, eighty, and five nines." It may mean eighty thousand plus forty-five, or some other total. I have kept the wording literal. In the verse, the term often rendered "major mark" is here used in its ordinary sense of "omen," paired with "bad dreams."

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.